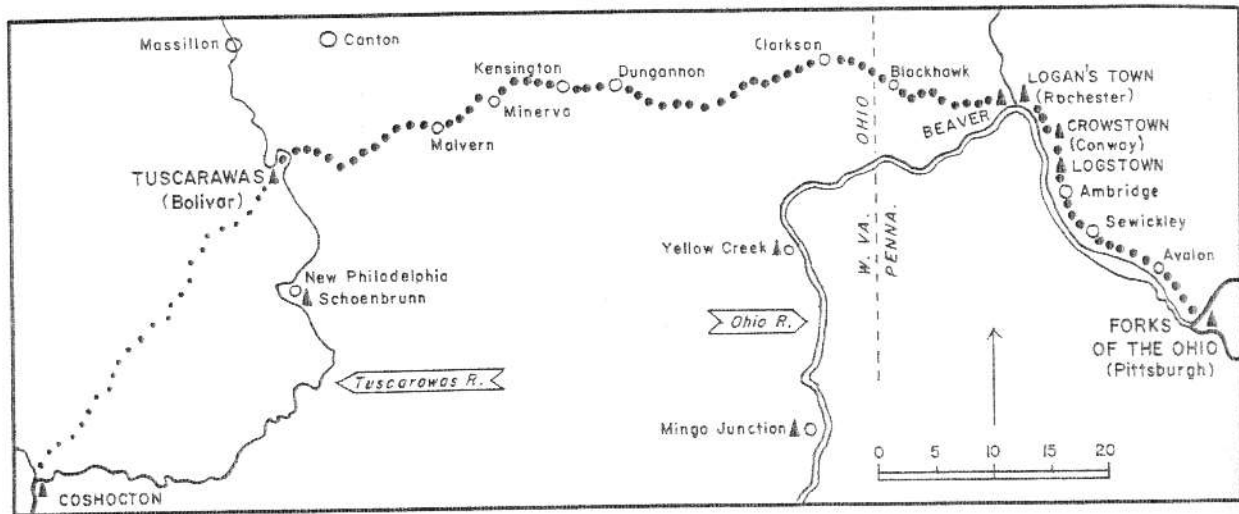


torical Society believes follows the old path closely to the ford of the Clarion River at Clew's Riffle. Since there is no bridge there, however, the motorist will have to return to Miola and cross the river at Clarion.

In the town of Clarion, turn left (east) on U. S. 322 and follow it to Strattanville, where the

Indian path is picked up again. Continue on 322 through Corsica, Brookville, and Reynoldsville to Luthersburg, which is the junction point with the Great Shamokin Path (*q.v.*).

¹The spelling adopted for this name (English, *Goshgoshink*) is one used by the German Moravians. It is chosen because the Moravian records provide our principal source of information about the place.



GREAT PATH

33. Great Path

From Pittsburgh to Detroit

The Great Path crossed the Allegheny River at Pittsburgh, ran along the west side of the Ohio River through Avalon, Sewickley, Logstown (Legionville, two miles north of Ambridge), and Crow's Town (Conway) to Logan's Town (Rochester) and Beaver's Town at the mouth of the Beaver River. In the western outskirts of Beaver, the path turned away from the Ohio River and ran through Blackhawk and Clarkson to the Ohio line. In Ohio it ran through Dungannon, Kensington, Minerva, and Malvern to the Indian town of Tuscarawas (Bolivar) on the Muskingum (now the Tuscarawas) River. It crossed the river about a mile above the town. This eastern section was sometimes called the Tuscarawas Path.

Thomas Hutchins, the surveyor, in his "Description of part of the Country Westward of the River Ohio, 1765," tells what he had seen of the Pennsylvania end of this path:

From Fort Pitt to big Beaver Creek by land is 28 Miles the Path is mostly along the River side and crosses a Number of small Ridges that Border on the River—Little Beaver Creek is 16 Miles further, for the first two Miles the Woods is very Levell at the End which is a Run [Twomile Run] and a very Steep & Difficult Ridge which may be Avoided by inclining about half a Mile to the Right of the Path, the Country then is made up of small broken Hills all the way to Little Beaver Creek, the Descent to which is Steep, this Creek is 60 yards wide and has a very good Fording. . . .¹

From Tuscarawas, according to John Heckewelder's map of the Ohio Country (1796), the main branch of the path went on "to Sandusky and Detroit," while another branch went south "to the Shawnee Towns on Sciota and Miami."

Colonel Henry Bouquet, when he led his expeditionary force in 1764 to Coshocton for the treaty that ended Pontiac's War, followed the

Great Path as far as Tuscarawas. Our best knowledge of the route comes from a map of the Ohio Country made in the same year by Hutchins, who traced it from his own surveys. Edward G. Williams, editor of Bouquet's *Orderly Book*,² has transferred it to a modern map.

During the latter half of the eighteenth century, the Great Path was, as its name suggests, a much-traveled highway. Archer Butler Hulbert in his *Red-Men's Roads: The Indian Thoroughfares of the Central West*, calls it "the most important trail of the central west, the main thoroughfare from Fort Pitt to Fort Detroit. It was the western extension," he continues, "of the continental route from the seaboard to the northwest, meeting Nemacolin's Path, which came from Fort Cumberland, at Fort Pitt."³

The name Great Path was sometimes given also to the Frankstown Path from the Susquehanna to the Forks of the Ohio. At the Forks, it

made connection with the path to Detroit described above.

FOR THE MOTORIST

From Pittsburgh, take Pa. 65 to Beaver. From Beaver follow S. R. 4028 for about 6 miles and then turn right on S. R. 4022, which runs to Blackhawk and the Ohio border.

There is no through road from there to Bolivar, but U. S. 30 (the Lincoln Highway) follows the path fairly closely from Kensington to Minerva. From there Ohio 80 will take you through Malvern to Waynesburg and Magnolia, all close to the Great Path. Thence Bouquet's road cut across to the vicinity of East Sparks and so went to Bolivar (Tuscarawas).

¹ Historical Society of Pennsylvania.

² "The Orderly Book of Colonel Henry Bouquet's Expedition Against the Ohio Indians, 1764," *Western Pennsylvania Historical Magazine*, XLII (1959), 16-17.

³ (Cleveland, Ohio, 1900), 10.

34. Great Island Path

From Sunbury to Lock Haven

The Great Island Path, according to J. P. Meginness,¹ crossed the Susquehanna River at Shamokin (Sunbury) and ascended the ravine on the west side from a point about a quarter of a mile south of the present bridge across the West Branch to Northumberland. For about three miles it followed the ridge which forms the boundary between Snyder and Union counties; "... then turning towards the river," as Meginness writes, "it passed over the hill upon the Merrill place; thence followed the river bank through Winfield and Lewisburg; thence to Buffalo Creek, where the iron bridge now spans it. It then curved to the river and passed through Shikellimy's Town [three-quarters of a mile south of West Milton] ... and along the river road, around the rocks"² north of the village of White Deer, into White Deer Hole Valley; thence to the vicinity of Elimsport and over North White Deer Ridge into Nippenose Valley, up which it ran to its head. It then passed through the gap in Bald Eagle Mountain to Lock Haven Reservoir on McElhattan Creek, Shoemaker Park, and Youngdale. There turning southwest, it followed the

West Branch of the Susquehanna to the Great Island (Lock Haven).

FOR THE MOTORIST

From White Deer to Allenwood, take U. S. 15. At Allenwood turn left on Pa. 44 through Elimsport and over North White Deer Ridge to Colomsville and Oval. Veer left at Oval on S. R. 3002 and follow it to Oriole. From there no road follows the course of the Great Island Path over Bald Eagle Mountain to the Lock Haven Reservoir; but the motorist will get a good idea of the obstacles before the path if he continues from Oriole as directly west as he can go, crosses Pa. 880, which in about a mile runs into S. R. 2010 at the head of Nippenose Valley. From here he turns right and crosses Bald Eagle Mountain on a Forestry Road through the gorge of Love Run. At Pine, turn left (west) on S. R. 2012 for Youngdale. From Youngdale an excursion may be made up McElhattan Creek to the Lock Haven Reservoir in order to see the cleft through which the Great Island Path came down off Bald Eagle Mountain. From Youngdale continue on 2012